

Self-Study Discussion 1.3 Suggested Solution

Create a discussion post and answer the following questions:

1. Will the costs for integrating your virtual assistant device with NLP align with the development costs itemized in the spreadsheet?

Answer: No. Not all of the costs for integrating the virtual assistant device with NLP align with the development costs itemized in the spreadsheet. A typical integration will have the following costs:

- a. Hardware costs
- b. Software development
- c. Data acquisition and annotation
- d. Model training and optimization
- e. Integration with Alexa skills
- f. Privacy and security
- g. User experience testing
- h. Maintenance and updates

2. In which areas can you reduce your development costs?

Answer: If licenses are already in place, then the allotment for the license cost can be reduced.

3. In which areas will your development costs exceed the estimates presented in the spreadsheet?

Answer: The development costs would exceed the estimates presented in the spreadsheet in the areas of data acquisition, model training and optimization, integration with Alexa skills, and user experience testing. According to the estimate sheet, no budget is allocated for these areas.

4. Does the spreadsheet account for the costs of your data needs?

Answer: No. However, there is a budget allocated for database user licenses.

5. What is your contingency plan if you exceed your resources or allotted project development time?

1. Identify the reasons for budget overrun.
2. Reassess the project scope.
3. Identify the crucial deliverables and focus on completing them within the remaining budget.
4. Negotiate for alternatives from vendors and suppliers at a lower cost.
5. Update the project plan accordingly.

6. Is this plan worth funding? Why or why not?

Answer: This is the project scope. The project scope should be strong enough that the plan is worth funding. In the case of NLP additions to an existing Alexa project, the need for the change has to be justified in the project scope before the budget allocation.